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Question 1 and 3 are for the participants whose Birthday is from Jan to June. Question 2 and 4 are for the participants whose Birthday is from July to December.

General Instructions

INSTRUCTIONS

Listening Test Instructions

Thank you for participating in this listening study!

What You Will Hear

In each question, you will hear three music clips:

- **One original clip**
- **Two edited versions** derived from the same original clip

All clips are short excerpts and may be replayed as many times as you like.

Your Task

For each question, you will be asked to focus on one specific musical aspect, such as:

- Harmony
- Rhythm & Meter
- Structural Form
- Melodic Content & Motifs

Your task is to compare the two edited clips and decide which one is farther from the original one with respect to that aspect.

How to Answer

After listening, select one of the following options:

- Edited Clip A is farther from the original
- Edited Clip B is farther from the original
- The difference is negligible (use this option only if you cannot make a decision after careful listening)

Important Notes

- Please **focus only on the specified musical aspect** for each question. Ignore other differences.
- You may **listen to each clip multiple times** before making a decision.
- Use **headphones or a quiet environment** if possible for better listening quality.
- Some differences may be subtle — please rely on your best judgment.

Begin questions

Section 1 — Harmony

Example

Harmony

DEFINITION

Harmony refers to the overall tonal character of a piece — the sense of which musical key it is in, how the pitch classes (notes) are distributed over time, and how consistently the music stays within a tonal center.

ONLY FOCUS ON

- The overall key or tonal center of the music (does the edited clip feel like it is in the same key as the original?)
- The distribution and balance of pitches across the piece (do the same notes dominate in both clips?)
- The moment-to-moment consistency of tonal color (does the harmonic atmosphere evolve in the same way?)
- Ignore all other music facets except Harmony

EXAMPLE

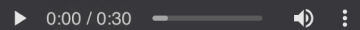
Listen to the example below. The correct answer is revealed afterward.

CLIP	EDIT
Original	no edit
A	no edit (identical to original)
B	+6 semitones (tritone)

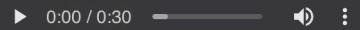
Original



Clip A



Clip B



Correct answer: B is farther from the original.

Clip A is identical to the original, while Clip B has been shifted up by 6 semitones (a tritone), changing both the key and the pitch-class distribution. Therefore B is farther from the original in terms of harmony.

Start section

Question 1

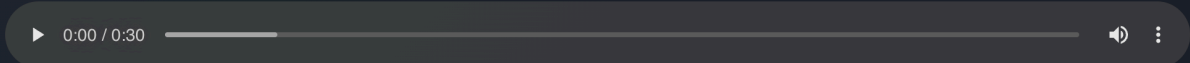
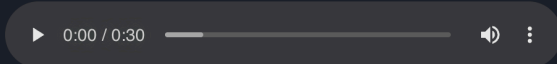
Harmony

[Read instructions](#)

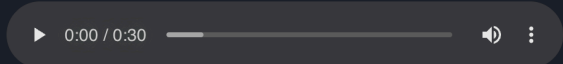
QUESTION 1 OF 2

Which edited clip is farther from the original in terms of harmony?

Listen to each audio clip as many times as needed

Original audio**Edited version A**

☐ A is farther from the original

Edited version B

☐ B is farther from the original

☐ The difference is negligible

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Clip	Edit
Original	no edit
A	+7 semitones (perfect 5th)
B	+6 semitones (tritone)
Answer	A

Question 2

Clip	Edit
Original	no edit
A	+4 semitones (major 3rd)
B	+6 semitones (tritone)
Answer	B

Question 3

Clip	Edit
Original	no edit
A	+5 semitones (perfect 4th)
B	+2 semitones (major 2nd)
Answer	A

Question 4

Clip	Edit
Original	no edit
A	+7 semitones (perfect 5th)
B	+4 semitones (major 3rd)
Answer	A



Section 2 — Structural Form

Example

Structural Form

DEFINITION

Structural Form refers to how a piece of music is organized at a large scale — how it is divided into distinct sections (such as verse, chorus, or bridge), whether those sections repeat or contrast with each other, and how clearly the boundaries between sections are marked.

ONLY FOCUS ON

- The number and placement of section boundaries (does the edited clip divide into sections at roughly the same moments as the original, or do the transitions feel shifted, missing, or added?)
- The repetition and contrast pattern of sections (does the edited clip follow the same large-scale pattern as the original — for example, does a section that repeated in the original still repeat, and does a section that contrasted still contrast?)
- The distinctiveness of section boundaries (are the transitions between sections equally clear and noticeable, or do they feel blurred or abrupt compared to the original?)
- Ignore all other music facets except Structural Form

EXAMPLE

Listen to the example below. The correct answer is revealed afterward.

CLIP	EDIT
Original	no edit (ABC)
A	no edit (identical to original)
B	AAA (all three sections replaced with repetitions of section A)

Original

▶ 0:00 / 0:40   ⋮

Clip A

▶ 0:00 / 0:40   ⋮

Clip B

▶ 0:00 / 0:41   ⋮

Correct answer: B is farther from the original.

Clip A is identical to the original. In Clip B, the two contrasting sections have been replaced with repetitions of the opening section — the music no longer has any contrast, and the entire clip sounds the same throughout. Therefore B is farther from the original in terms of structural form.

Start section

Question 1

Clip	Edit
Original	no edit (ABC)
A	ABA (section C replaced with repeat of A)
B	AAA (all three sections replaced with A)
Answer	B

Question 2

Clip	Edit
Original	no edit (ABC)
A	CBA (all three sections preserved, order reversed)
B	ABB (section C replaced with repeat of B)
Answer	A

Question 3

Clip	Edit
Original	no edit (ABC)
A	ABB (C replaced with B, B occupies 2/3)
B	BBB (all replaced with B)
Answer	B

Question 4

Clip	Edit
Original	no edit (ABC)
A	ACB (B and C swapped)
B	AAB (C replaced with A; A occupies 2/3)
Answer	B

Section 3 — Rhythm & Meter

Example

Rhythm & Meter

DEFINITION

Rhythm & Meter refers to the temporal structure of a piece — how fast the music moves (tempo), where the beats fall in time, and how steadily the rhythmic pulse is maintained across the piece.

ONLY FOCUS ON

- The overall tempo or speed of the music (does the edited clip feel like it moves at the same pace as the original?)
- The placement and regularity of beats (do the beats land at the expected moments, or do they feel shifted, rushed, or dragged?)
- The steadiness of the rhythmic pulse (does the music maintain a stable groove, or does it feel uneven, jittery, or unstable?)
- Ignore all other music facets except Rhythm & Meter

EXAMPLE

Listen to the example below. The correct answer is revealed afterward.

CLIP	EDIT
Original	no edit
A	no edit (identical to original)
B	tempo shifted +50%

Original

▶

0:00 / 0:30

🔊

⋮

Clip A

▶

0:00 / 0:30

🔊

⋮

Clip B

▶

0:00 / 0:30

🔊

⋮

Correct answer: B is farther from the original.

Clip A is identical to the original. Clip B has been sped up by 50%, making the music feel noticeably faster and changing where every beat lands. Therefore B is farther from the original in terms of rhythm & meter.

Start section

Question 1 (Sanity Check)

Clip	Edit
Original	no edit
A	no edit
B	tempo shifted +40%
Answer	B

Question 2

Clip	Edit
Original	no edit
A	tempo shifted +5%
B	tempo shifted +30%
Answer	B

Question 3

Clip	Edit
Original	no edit
A	all beats shifted later by a constant +150 ms
B	each beat independently randomized by ± 80 ms
Answer	A

Question 4 (Sanity Check)

Clip	Edit
Original	no edit
A	No edit
B	every beat delayed by a constant +50 ms throughout
Answer	Same



Section 4 — Melodic Content & Motifs

Example

Melodic Content & Motifs

DEFINITION

Melodic content refers to the shape and movement of the main tune — the sequence of pitches that rises and falls over time and forms the part of the music you would typically hum or sing along to. Motifs are short, recognizable melodic fragments (usually just a few notes) that recur throughout a piece and give it its identity — the "hook" or the little melodic idea you remember after listening.

ONLY FOCUS ON

- The overall shape of the main melody — does the tune rise and fall in the same way as the original?
- Whether the recurring short melodic fragments (motifs) from the original are still recognizable in the edited clip — can you still hear the same "little melodic ideas" coming back?
- The sequence of intervals between consecutive notes of the melody — does the melody move by the same steps and leaps as the original?
- Ignore all other music facets except Melodic Content & Motifs

EXAMPLE

Listen to the example below. The correct answer is revealed afterward.

CLIP	EDIT
Original	no edit
A	Melodic inversion (every interval direction of the main melody flipped: ascending becomes descending and vice versa)
B	+5 semitones (whole piece transposed up by a perfect 4th)

Original

▶ 0:00 / 1:13

Clip A

▶ 0:00 / 1:13

Clip B

▶ 0:00 / 1:13

Correct answer: A is farther from the original.

Clip B only shifts the entire piece to a different pitch level — the rise-and-fall shape and all recurring motifs are fully preserved, which we treat as negligible for melodic content. Clip A inverts every interval direction of the main melody, so the original ascending themes now descend and vice versa; the melodic shape and motifs are no longer recognizable. Therefore A is farther from the original.

Question 1 (Sanity Check)

Clip	Edit
Original	no edit
A	Melodic inversion of the main melody (every interval direction flipped)
B	+3 semitones (whole piece transposed up by a minor 3rd)
Answer	A

Question 2

Clip	Edit
Original	no edit
A	Melodic inversion applied to the entire main melody
B	Melodic inversion applied to only the second half of the main melody (first half unchanged)
Answer	A

Question 3

Clip	Edit
Original	no edit
A	All melodic intervals of the main melody multiplied by 3 (contour direction preserved, but every interval becomes a different interval class; motif identity destroyed)
B	Main melody pitch sequence reversed in time (rhythm and accompaniment unchanged; motifs still audible as their retrograde)
Answer	A

Question 4 (Sanity/Attention check)

Clip	Edit
Original	no edit
A	+7 semitones (whole piece transposed up by a perfect 5th)
B	-5 semitones (whole piece transposed down by a perfect 4th)
Answer	Same